Emmanuel Mendieta

Founding Engineer | Product & Engineering Lead

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SUMMARY

Three-time co-founder and former Lead Software Engineer at MARA. Raised a $250K pre-seed, led 7 engineers, and learned the hard way to talk first, then build.

SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks: TypeScript, Python, SQL, Next.js, React, Node.js, FastAPI
Infrastructure & Data: PostgreSQL, Supabase, Redis, Vercel, Cloudflare Workers, AWS S3, Docker
AI & APIs: OpenAI, Anthropic Claude, multi-agent systems, ElevenLabs, Stripe, Plaid, Salesforce API, Google APIs

EXPERIENCE

Queso Ventures — Founder
Jan 2026 – Present

- **Growth:** walked into businesses cold every day for months, then added referrals; grew to dozens of clients.
- **Land & Expand:** won local SMBs with websites and SEO, then built SaaS for more calls, regulars, and leads.
- **Automation:** architected the platform alone so all of Queso runs itself: onboarding, billing and collections, reminders, tool access, and client questions (Next.js, Postgres, Stripe, Plaid, SMS).
- **Sales Engine:** built lead scoring and AI website mockups that cut the sales cycle to same-day.

Fordra — Co-Founder
May 2026 – Present

- **Growth:** first paying lenders came from my Lever network; now growing via industry leaders and outbound.
- **Product:** lead AI insurance verification that lenders run inside their own Salesforce, every day.

Lazo — Co-Founder & CTO
Sep 2025 – Jan 2026

- **AI Agents:** sole engineer on a WhatsApp AI tutor running 8 specialized agents per message; 120 learners.
- **Decisions:** cut 8 languages to 2 from usage data, then called the shutdown when retention fell.

Lever — Co-Founder & CTO
Apr 2025 – Sep 2025

- **Fundraising:** raised a $250K pre-seed round and built a Bitcoin lending platform on Starknet.
- **Pivot:** moved to logistics factoring; cut carrier verification from days to 1 business day.

MARA Digital Holdings — Lead Software Engineer
Feb 2024 – Apr 2025

- **Leadership:** led 7 engineers and shipped 6 cross-chain fintech apps for a public company.
- **Revenue:** full-stack on Slipstream, a Bitcoin transaction accelerator: $500K+ in its first 4–6 weeks.
- **Tokenization:** led development of Avant, a real-world-asset platform holding $2.2M+.

Freelance — Software Engineer
Aug 2019 – Jun 2023

- **Clients:** 30+ paying, from online universities to local SMBs and biomedical software; Queso's foundation.

EDUCATION

University of Houston | B.S. Computer Science, Minor in Mathematics — May 2023

Built by Queso Ventures
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